

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's talk about family!



Learning Outcome

Describe routines and regular activities in a wider range of social and work contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What things do you do with your family during the week? On weekends? On holidays?

Can Do Statements

- I can ask about family members, their habits and traits.
- I can talk about behavior and personality.
- I can talk about what people are doing.





Let's Explore!

Vanessa **is in her element*** when she cooks.

* To *"be in your element"* means to be happy doing what you like to do or do best.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Vanessa:** What is your mum doing now that you're back on your own?
- Sally:** She's working through her daily routine again: cleaning, cooking, washing.
- Vanessa:** How old is she? Can I ask that?
- Sally:** She turns 46 soon. We have a big party for her every year. She's outgoing and loves family gatherings.
- Vanessa:** What's your dad like? You mentioned he's grumpy sometimes. How grumpy does he get?
- Sally:** Well, he can be quite irritable when he's overworked, and a bit short-tempered.
- Vanessa:** My family seems so different!
- Sally:** How different can it be?
- Vanessa:** Well, I come from a small family. They are exceptionally quiet. They hardly speak. They're always reading.
- Sally:** You are always in the kitchen banging pots and pans!
- Vanessa:** I rarely bang pots.
- Sally:** I know. You are so in your element when you cook.
- Vanessa:** I'm still learning. I am constantly finding new ways to combine flavor and food.
- Sally:** I am getting more and more organized. Blogging about my travels every day helped with that.
- Vanessa:** Look at us! Young confident working women!





Let's Practice!

Sally and Vanessa talk about their families!

Instructions: Read the dialogue again. What questions do Sally and Vanessa ask each other about their families? Select all the correct answers.

1. What is your mum doing now you're back on your own?
2. How is work these days?
3. How old is she?
4. What's your dad like?
5. When are we going out for dinner?
6. How grumpy does he get?
7. How different can your family be?



Let's Practice!

What do we find out about Sally and Vanessa's families?

Instructions: Match the sentences from column A and column B.

COLUMN A

1. We have a big party
2. My family seems
3. I come from
4. I am constantly finding
5. I am getting more
6. You are always in the

COLUMN B

- a. new ways to combine flavor and food.
- b. a small family.
- c. and more organized.
- d. kitchen banging pots and pans!
- e. so different!
- f. for her every year.





Extension Activity

Use regular adjectives to describe your family and friends.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write about 3 people you know well.
- Use adjectives to describe their personalities and their everyday lives.
- Write a short paragraph for each person with 25-30 words in each paragraph.
- Read your paragraphs to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write about 3 people I know.

☐ ☐

I describe their personalities.

☐ ☐

I describe their everyday lives.

☐ ☐

I read my descriptions aloud.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to clean** (verb): to tidy and do housework
e.g. I have to clean before my family arrives!
- to wash** (verb): to do the laundry
e.g. Tom washes his clothes on Saturdays.
- irritable** (adjective): easily annoyed
e.g. Dad is irritable when he's tired.
- over-worked** (adjective): having worked too long and too hard
e.g. Dad feels over-worked when he has a tight deadline.
- short-tempered** (adjective): easily angered
e.g. Ted is short-tempered, so watch what you say to him.
- to bang** (verb): to hit and make noise
e.g. She's banging pots and pans in the kitchen.
- organized** (adjective): being orderly and efficient
e.g. She is always so organized!





Learning Points

Talking About Family

When you talk about family, you often describe the behavior and personalities of the people in your family.

Behavior is the way a person acts or conducts themselves.

Example: Tom is usually relaxed, but today he seems nervous.

Personality is a person's general character (the way they are).

Example: Sandra is a tidy person. Her apartment is always clean and neat.

We use adjectives to talk about behavior and personality.

Adjective	Meaning
creative	artistic; has original ideas
loud	often speaks at full volume
angry	annoyed; hostile
sweet	even-tempered; pleasant
bookish	always reading
grumpy	crabby; bad-tempered
zany	eccentric; unusual
outgoing	friendly; socially confident
irritable	easily annoyed
short-tempered	easy to anger
quiet	silent; still
confident	positive; self-assured

Examples:

- *He can be a little grumpy sometimes.*
- *She never gets upset or angry.*
- *My cousin is really creative - he works as a graphic designer.*
- *I can be a little short-tempered.*





Learning Points

The Simple Present Tense versus The Present Continuous Tense

You use the Simple Present tense and the Present Continuous tense to talk about the present in different ways.

You use the Simple Present tense:

- to talk about things that are always true
- to give general information
- to talk about habits and routines
- to talk about feelings (stative verbs)

You use the Present Continuous tense:

- to talk about an action happening now
- to talk about things happening around now
- to talk about things that are changing

Simple Present Tense	Present Continuous Tense
<i>I read all the time.</i>	<i>I'm reading a good book this week.</i>
<i>We have a new car.</i>	<i>Tom is buying a new car today.</i>
<i>Water boils at 100 degrees C.</i>	<i>The water in the kettle is boiling.</i>

